

New Sites, Faces Mark Imminent 1966 Baseball Year

By JACK HAND
BY THE ASSOCIATED PRESS

Atlanta and Anaheim are big league, Sandy Koufax and Don Drysdale are filthy rich and Mickey Mantle still is a \$100,000 pinch hitter as the baseball season opens.

If the weather man behaves Monday and Tuesday the two-day program in 10 cities should attract about 320,000 curious fans. The largest turnout, 50,983, is expected to jam Atlanta's new stadium for the Braves' debut against Pittsburgh Tuesday night.

When Koufax and Drysdale finally agreed to let Walter O'Malley keep Chavez Ravine and signed for \$240,000, the Las Vegas odds-makers quickly shuffled their morning line to re-establish the Los Angeles Dodgers as favorites in the National League. They can't agree on the American League race, making the defending champion Minnesota Twins and the Baltimore Orioles the co-favorites.

Six new or slightly used managers will be arguing with umpires, matching brain waves and juggling talent. Casey Stengel, safe in the Hall of Fame, will be home in California scouting the league for the New York Mets.

Leo Durocher is back after 11 years as a coach, television star and bon vivant, and resumes his managerial career with the Cubs in Chicago where his crosstown rival will be Eddie Stanky, an old sidekick who has succeeded Al Lopez with the White Sox.

boys with the New York Giants. He is the new boss at Kansas City and Wes Westrum, another member of the club, has moved up from acting manager to official manager of the Mets.

Don Heffner, a minor league manager for years and more recently a coach of the Mets under Stengel, is the new skipper at Cincinnati and Grady Hatton has taken over in the dome at Houston.

The map of baseball constantly is being redrawn. This year is no exception. The restless Braves, forced to remain in Milwaukee a year longer than they wanted, finally will open in Atlanta after long legal battle.

The California Angels, known

previous as the Los Angeles Angels, are moving into their new park at Anaheim, a whoop and a holler from Disneyland.

St. Louis also will have a new park ready in mid-May but the Cardinals will open in old Busch Stadium and play some home games in that ancient arena with its handy right field pavilion.

FRICK DEPARTS
Ford Frick has left the scene and William D. Eckert, a retired Air Force general, has taken his place as commissioner. Eckert spent the spring in Florida, warming up for many opening day ceremonies.

Mantle, still unable to throw after undergoing surgery on his right shoulder during the winter.

is strictly a pinch hitter with the Yankees but other ailing members of the cast appear to have made comebacks.

Robin Roberts, carried as a Houston coach on the winter roster, has found his arm so strong that he will be the opening day pitcher for the Astros.

Roger Maris is swinging the bat again for the Yanks after missing most of 1965. Pittsburgh's Vern Law appears to be sound again but the Yanks' Jim Bouton has been having problems finding his fast ball. Al Kaline of Detroit is feeling frisky after an operation on his foot.

ROOKIES AVERAGE

The rookie crop appears about average. Houston is high on shortstop Sonny Jackson and the Yanks think they have found help in outfielder Roy White, shortstop Bobby Murcer and pitcher Fritz Peterson.

Cincinnati likes Tommy Helms so much that the Reds have revised their infield, moving All-

Star second baseman Pete Rose to third base and Deron Johnson to the outfield.
George Scott, up from the

Eastern League, has beaten out highly touted Joe Foy, in a battle of rookies for third base with Boston. Tommy Agee is being called, perhaps with too much enthusiasm, another Willie Mays.

Red Schoendienst is counting on George Kernek, a rookie from the Jacksonville farm, to fill Bill White's shoes at St. Louis. Fred Valentine has won a regular outfield job with Washington and Baltimore's opening day catcher will be Andy Etchebarren, a

newcomer from Rochester. The Angels think Rick Reichardt is ready to start living up to his big bonus.

TWO MONDAY GAMES

There will be two Monday games, the customary Presidential special in Washington and

the traditional opener at Cincinnati.

will try to make it at Washington when the Senators take on the Cleveland Indians.

Birdie Tebbetts, manager of

the Indians, is thinking pennant and is leading with Sam McDowell, one of the best pitchers in the league. Pete Richert is supposed to go for the Senators before a capacity crowd of 46,019.

Cincinnati also will pack them in to the tune of some 30,000 to watch the revamped Reds, minus Frank Robinson but plus Milt Pappas and Jack Baldschun, make their bow against the Mets in the only duel of new managers. The Mets, encouraged by a fine spring, probably will send Jack

Fisher against either Pappas, the new pitcher from Baltimore, or Sammy Ellis.

All of the other teams open Tuesday in an eight-game program that includes night action in Los Angeles, St. Louis and Atlanta of the National League.

TWINS AT HOME

where they closed it last October in the seventh game of the World Series. They expect about 27,000 to watch Jim Grant or Camilo

The defending world champion Dodgers also will be at home but they will be playing a night game

San Francisco will be at home Tuesday afternoon with 42,500, in the stands for the game with Chicago. Ernie Broglio is due to work against Juan Marichal and Willie Mays is due to work out as

St. Louis opens for the last time in the old park against the Philadelphia Phillies. Cardinal fans, 24,000-strong, will get a chance for a quick evaluation of the controversial winter deal that sent Bill White and Dick Groat to the

Phils and brought Alex Johnson and Art Mahaffey to the Birds.

with the ambitious Pittsburgh Pirates, who think they have a real shot at the pennant, mixing with the transplanted Braves.

The Yanks, still embarrassed by that sixth-place slump, of 1965, hope to start rebounding against Detroit which has been picked to win the pennant in

Stanky's White Sox, a hot team in Florida, will open at Comiskey Park against the Angels before 25,000. Boston, still shuffling players in deals, will be at home

Everybody is predicting tight races in both leagues. That is the standard procedure at this time of the year. This time, however,

it appears to be on the level. If anybody runs off and hides it will be a scandal.